

# THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 45952.24 ▼ 301.07 0.65%

NASDAQ 22562.54 ▼ 0.5%

STOXX 600 571.66 ▲ 0.7%

10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 18/32, yield 3.976%

OIL \$57.46 ▼ \$0.81

GOLD \$4,280.20 ▲ \$103.30

EURO \$1.1689

YEN 150.44

## What's News

### Business & Finance

- ◆ **An increasing glut** of oil and fear of a global economic slowdown have pushed U.S. crude prices to their lowest point since fuel markets were rebounding from the Covid crash. **A1**
- ◆ **Regional banks came** under renewed scrutiny after Zions Bancorp said it would take a large loss and revealed accusations of fraud against a set of borrowers who had ties to other lenders. **B1**
- ◆ **Nestlé said it would cut** 16,000 jobs and take a fresh look at exiting some of its 2,000-plus brands. **B1**
- ◆ **College and university** endowments have posted their strongest returns in several years, with stock investments of all types driving gains. **B1**
- ◆ **The Dow, S&P 500** and Nasdaq fell 0.7%, 0.6% and 0.5%, respectively. **B8**
- ◆ **TSMC raised its outlook** further as profit for the third quarter soared to a record. **B4**
- ◆ **EU goods exports** to the U.S. tumbled in August after a tariff deal that ramped up duties on most products from the economic bloc. **A2**
- ◆ **Giorgio Armani named** executive Giuseppe Marsocci as chief executive officer. **B3**
- ◆ **ABB posted an increase** in third-quarter revenue and profit, and appointed Christian Nilsson as its CFO. **B3**
- ◆ **Foxconn Technology's** shares surged, after its chairman said he met with ChatGPT maker OpenAI. **B4**
- ◆ **The federal government** ended fiscal year 2025 with a deficit of \$1.775 trillion, down about \$41 billion or 2% from the year before. **A2**

### World-Wide

- ◆ **The Justice Department** secured an indictment against John Bolton, Trump's former national security adviser turned opponent, after an investigation into his handling of classified information. **A1**
- ◆ **The parent company** of voting-technology provider Smartmatic was indicted on charges of foreign bribery. **A4**
- ◆ **Venezuela is moving** troops into position on the Caribbean coast and mobilizing what Maduro asserts is a millions-strong militia in a display of defiance against a U.S. military buildup. **A1**
- ◆ **The U.S. Navy** admiral in charge of U.S. Southern Command will step down. **A6**
- ◆ **A federal judge will** order federal agents engaged in an immigration enforcement push in the Chicago area to wear and use body cameras. **A3**
- ◆ **The U.S. Chamber** of Commerce sued the Trump administration over new fees in the H-1B visa program. **A3**
- ◆ **Trump said that he would** meet soon with Putin in Budapest for talks on ending the war in Ukraine. **A7**
- ◆ **Trump is weighing** whether providing Tomahawk cruise missiles to Ukraine would drive Putin to the negotiating table. **A7**
- ◆ **JB Pritzker**, governor of Illinois, recounted his \$14 million blackjack winnings when asked about a 2024 tax return. **A4**
- ◆ **An Israeli airstrike** killed the Houthis' military chief of staff, the most senior official of the Yemeni rebel group to be killed by Israel. **A16**
- ◆ **Died: Ace Frehley**, 74, co-founder of rock band Kiss. **A4**

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## Violence Mars Mourning for Kenyan Politician



THOMAS MUKOYA/REUTERS

**UNREST:** The military tried to disperse crowds and police opened fire Thursday, killing two people, as they sought to control the thousands gathered for a public viewing in Nairobi of the body of former Prime Minister Raila Odinga, who died at age 80. **A16**

## Venezuela Girds for U.S. Fight, But Its Defenses Are Vulnerable

Aggressive posturing in face of American pressure belies lack of military strength

Venezuela is moving troops into position on the Caribbean coast and mobilizing what President Nicolás Maduro asserts is

By Juan Forero, Kejal Vyas, José de Córdoba and Lara Seligman

a millions-strong militia in a display of defiance against the biggest U.S. military buildup in the Caribbean since the 1980s.

The strongman's regime has cranked up its propaganda machine. On state television, radio and social media, announcers are telling Venezuelans that the U.S. is a rapacious Nazi-like state that wants to dig its claws into the country's oil wealth, but that the country's military, the National Bolivarian Armed Forces, are positioning to repel any invasion.

Footage has shown militia members—men and women, often elderly, slightly plump Venezuelans—running obstacle courses, crawling under barbed wire and firing rifles. The Venezuelan armed forces, which military experts said on paper numbers 125,000 sol-

diers, is shown marching in formation, with soldiers getting on top of armored vehicles and moving boxes of munitions to and fro. The country's Russian-made jet fighters are featured in footage shooting across the skies.

"The people are ready for combat, ready for battle," Maduro told a crowd of supporters this week. "Venezuela will not be humiliated. Venezuela will bow to no one. Venezuela will continue on its path of peace, harmony, and stability."

The regime's aggressive posturing obscures the vulnerability of its armed forces against the world's most powerful military. Military experts

said the U.S. buildup isn't enough to support an invasion of Venezuela, but it is enough to support sustained strikes on boats allegedly carrying drugs to the U.S. or to even bomb targets on Venezuela's soil, as President Trump has warned.

The U.S. has moved advanced weaponry into the Caribbean and in the skies north of Venezuela, including eight Navy warships, an attack submarine, F-35B jet fighters, P-8 Poseidon spy planes and MQ-9 Reaper drones.

The Pentagon has deployed

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◆ **Southern Command head** to step down..... **A6**

## Oil Prices Tumble To Lowest Level Since '21

Oversupply, fear of economic slowdown jolt energy markets, portend cheaper fuel

By RYAN DEZEMBER

A growing glut of oil and fear of a global economic slowdown pushed crude prices to their lowest point since fuel markets were rebounding from the Covid-19 crash.

Most actively traded U.S. oil futures ended Thursday at \$56.99 a barrel, down 2.2% on the day and 19% from a year ago. That marked the lowest price since February 2021. Declines this week bring prices below the depths of the spring selloff when President Trump unleashed a barrage of tariffs and sparked worries of economic turmoil.

The decline is good for U.S. consumers because cheaper crude portends lower prices for gasoline, diesel, jet fuel and heating oil. But it is an alarming situation for a U.S. oil industry already beset by narrowing profit margins and shedding jobs by the thousands.

In many states, including Michigan, Ohio, Texas and Colorado, the average price has already dropped below \$3 a gallon. The Energy Information Administration earlier this month forecast a national average of \$2.90 a gallon next year.

Trump, a Republican, promised lower fuel prices to voters and has spent much of this term dismantling his predecessor's efforts to foster renewable-energy development in favor of fossil fuels. He has encouraged drilling at both

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◆ **India counters Trump claim** it will drop Russian oil... **A16**

## Data Centers Build Their Own Power

Desperate for electricity, tech companies are bypassing the grid

By JENNIFER HILLER

Tech companies in the AI race need power, and lots of it. They aren't waiting around for the archaic U.S. power grid to catch up.

In West Texas, natural-gas-fired power generation is under construction as part of the \$500 billion Stargate project from OpenAI and Oracle. Gas turbines are in use at Colossus 1 and 2, the massive data centers Elon Musk's xAI is building in

Memphis, Tenn. More than a dozen Equinix data centers across the country are using fuel cells for power.

With the push for AI dominance at warp speed, the "Bring Your Own Power" boom is a quick fix for the gridlock of trying to get on the grid. It's driving an energy Wild West that is reshaping American power.

Most tech titans would be happy to trade their DIY sourcing for the ability to

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## TiVo Has Sold Its Last DVR. These People Refuse to Let Go.

The world has passed the device by, but fans plan to use it until the bitter end

ANN-MARIE ALCÁNTARA

Amy Suggars bought her first TiVo about 14 years ago and has been attached to the video-recording device ever since.

But this month brought a double blow: First, TiVo announced it would no longer sell its physical DVR products. A few days later, her device died.

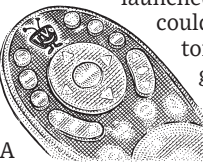
"I hung on as long as I could, but I would've hung on longer if TiVo hadn't taken the decision out of my hands," said Suggars, a 65-year-old biology professor and

owner of a pet sitting business in Delaware, Ohio.

Like Netflix's DVD-rental business, TiVo helped revolutionize how viewers watched cable television when it launched in 1999. People could record shows, customize their program guide to see only the channels they cared for and skip commercials—much to the disdain of advertisers and network TV.

The device—and its "badoop" remote-control sound—wedged its way into pop culture, with references to TiVo on episodes of

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Show's over

## INSIDE



### MANSION

Wealthy home buyers are trading slopeside for golf communities near the mountains. **M1**

### JASON GAY

The 58-year-old trying to break into college football—is basketball next? **A12**

## New Citi Premium Card Became Ordeal for Users

By IMANI MOISE

When Brad Collett heard about Citi's new Strata Elite credit card—with perks like airport lounge access and a dedicated service line for top-tier customers—he decided to splurge on his first premium card. The customer-service nightmare that followed convinced Collett to file his first complaint with federal regulators.

Across the country, Citi Strata Elite customers said they have been locked out of their accounts for weeks, unable to make purchases or redeem rewards that cost an annual fee of \$595. To unlock the cards and rewards, the bank is requiring customers to submit an income-verification form from the Internal Revenue Service.

## Bolton Is Latest Trump Adversary To Be Indicted

By SADIE GURMAN AND C. RYAN BARBER

GREENBELT, Md.—The Justice Department on Thursday secured an indictment against John Bolton for allegedly mishandling classified information, making President Trump's former national security adviser the latest of his prominent critics to face prosecution.

Prosecutors said in court papers that Bolton, 76 years old, shared with two relatives more than 1,000 pages of "diary-like" entries that con-

tained classified information about his daily activities as national security adviser. He would send the entries electronically, sometimes from his private AOL and Google email accounts, prosecutors said. The documents don't identify the recipients, but people familiar with the matter said they were Bolton's wife and daughter.

The indictment indicates

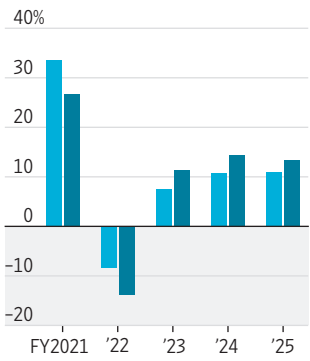
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◆ **Smartmatic indicted over** alleged bribes..... **A4**

## Endowment Gains Surge

Many colleges earned robust returns last year, though battles with the White House are keeping schools on edge. **B1**

■ Median endowment return  
■ 70% stock/30% bonds benchmark portfolio total-return



Note: Years are fiscal years ended June 30.

Benchmark portfolio is made up of 70% global stocks and 30% high-quality U.S. bonds. Endowment-return data for 2025 are preliminary. Source: Cambridge Associates